FORM & FOUNDRY

We forge brands.

BRAND GUIDELINES · VERSION 1.0 · 19 OCTOBER 2026

BRAND IDENTITY & GUIDELINES BY LYKO ARTISTRY

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BRAND INTRODUCTION

Form & Foundry — Brand Guidelines

Brand Overview

Form & Foundry is a brand strategy and growth consultancy that helps ambitious companies turn raw ideas into distinctive, market-ready brands — combining strategic positioning with hands-on identity design and digital execution.

Brand Story

Form & Foundry started from a simple frustration: most branding work stops at a logo, and most strategy work never becomes anything visible. We built a studio that does both — strategy that gets built, and design that's strategically grounded.

Mission

To forge brands with enough clarity to be understood in seconds, and enough craft to be remembered for years.

Vision

A world where every growing business has a brand as sharp as its ambition — not just a logo, but a full system for how it looks, sounds, and grows.

Brand Promise

We take a raw idea and forge it into a brand people remember.

Target Audience

Founders, marketing leads, and product teams at ambitious startups and scaling SMEs who need their brand to work harder — across identity, digital product, and marketing.

Core Values

- Craft over convention
- Strategy before style
- Momentum — bias to shipping
- Boldness with intent
- Collaboration, not hand-off

Brand Positioning

Form & Foundry is the brand and growth partner for founders who are ready to stand out, not blend in — pairing sharp strategic thinking with distinctive design execution.

Personality

The creative collaborator with sharp instincts — energetic, direct, a little irreverent, always backed by a clear strategic reason for every creative choice.

BRAND STRATEGY

Form & Foundry — Brand Guidelines

Market Positioning

Positioned as the modern alternative to traditional branding agencies — faster, leaner, more collaborative, without sacrificing strategic rigour or design craft.

Unique Value Proposition

Strategy and design in one team, one sprint, one shared source of truth — no hand-off gap between the thinking and the making.

Competitive Differentiation

Most agencies split strategy and execution across teams or vendors. Form & Foundry keeps both in the same room, so nothing gets lost in translation.

Customer Perception (Goal)

“They didn’t just give us a brand — they gave us a way of thinking about our own business that we still use.”

Brand Pillars

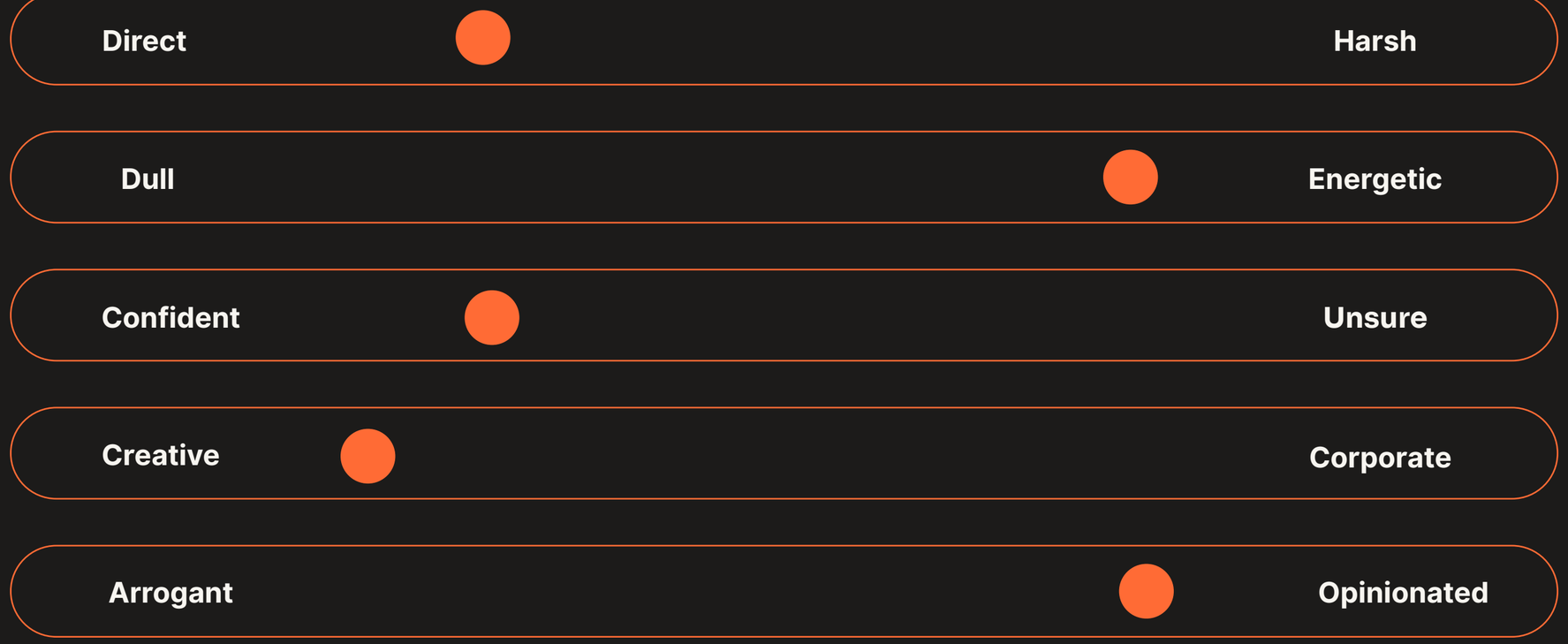
Craft
Every detail is made, not defaulted.

Momentum
Ideas ship; progress beats perfection.

Distinction
If it could be anyone's, it isn't ours.

Partnership
Strategy and design in one room, with you.

Build
Strategy becomes whatyou can see and use.



Tone of Voice

Confident, energetic, a little irreverent — direct without being harsh, opinionated without being arrogant. Talks like a sharp creative partner, not a corporate vendor.

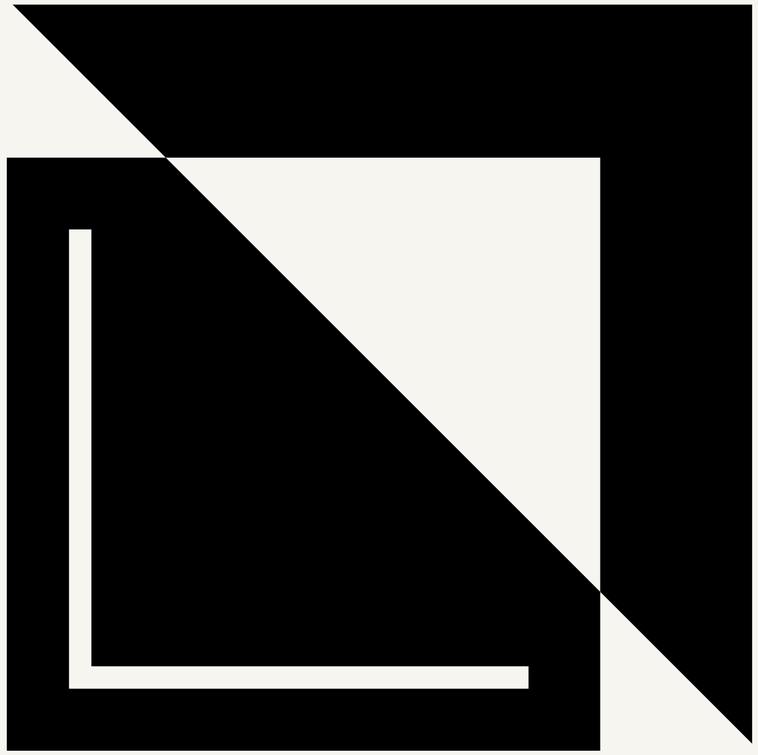
LOGO SYSTEM

Form & Foundry — Brand Guidelines

Primary Logo

The stacked lockup is the default Form & Foundry logo: the forged-block mark above the wordmark, centred. Reach for it first. It suits any square or portrait space — covers, title slides, social profile images, packaging, and merchandise.

The wordmark is set in Sora Bold, all capitals, with the standard Sora ampersand. The mark carries the distinctiveness; the wordmark stays plain so the two never compete.



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Secondary Logo

The horizontal lockup places the mark to the left of the wordmark on a single line. Use it when height is tight and width is generous — website and document headers, email signatures, slide footers, and fascia signage. When both lockups fit, choose the primary.

Always place the supplied artwork. Never rebuild either lockup by hand.

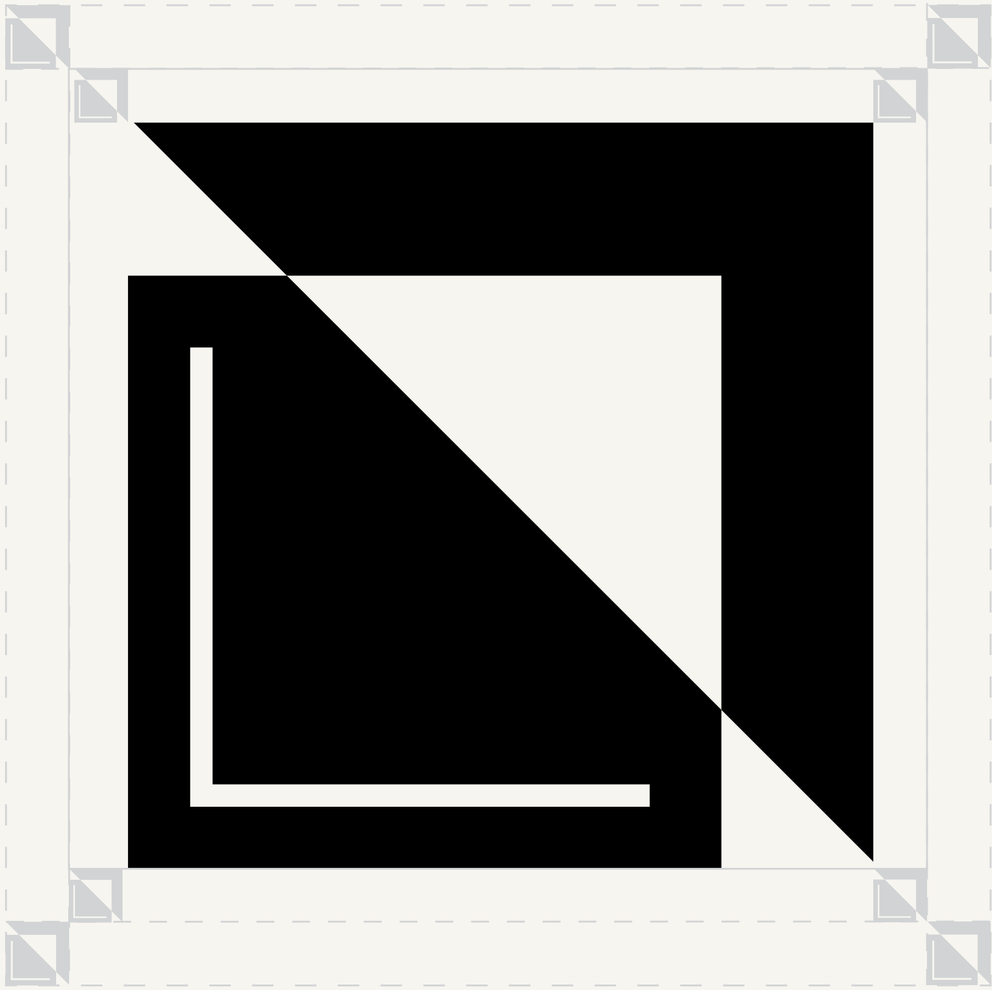


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Logomark

A single modular block — a square bisected by a diagonal — representing “raw material becoming shape”.

Use the mark on its own once the audience already knows the brand: favicons, app icons, social avatars, stickers, embossing, and as a source for patterns. Introduce Form & Foundry to a new audience with a full lockup first.



Wordmark

“Form & Foundry” set alone, without the mark. Reserve it for tight horizontal spaces where the mark would fall below its minimum size — email footers, narrow app headers, co-branding lines, and credits in running text.

Clear Space

Keep a clear space of X on every side of every logo version, where X is one-sixth of the block mark’s width. The corner squares in the diagram show X. No type, imagery, page edges, or other logos may enter this zone.† For the wordmark alone, use the same X taken from the full lockup.†



Logo Construction

The logo is built from a single block. Every proportion below comes from the block mark, drawn at 304.5 × 304.5 px for the stacked lockup.

MEASUREMENTS

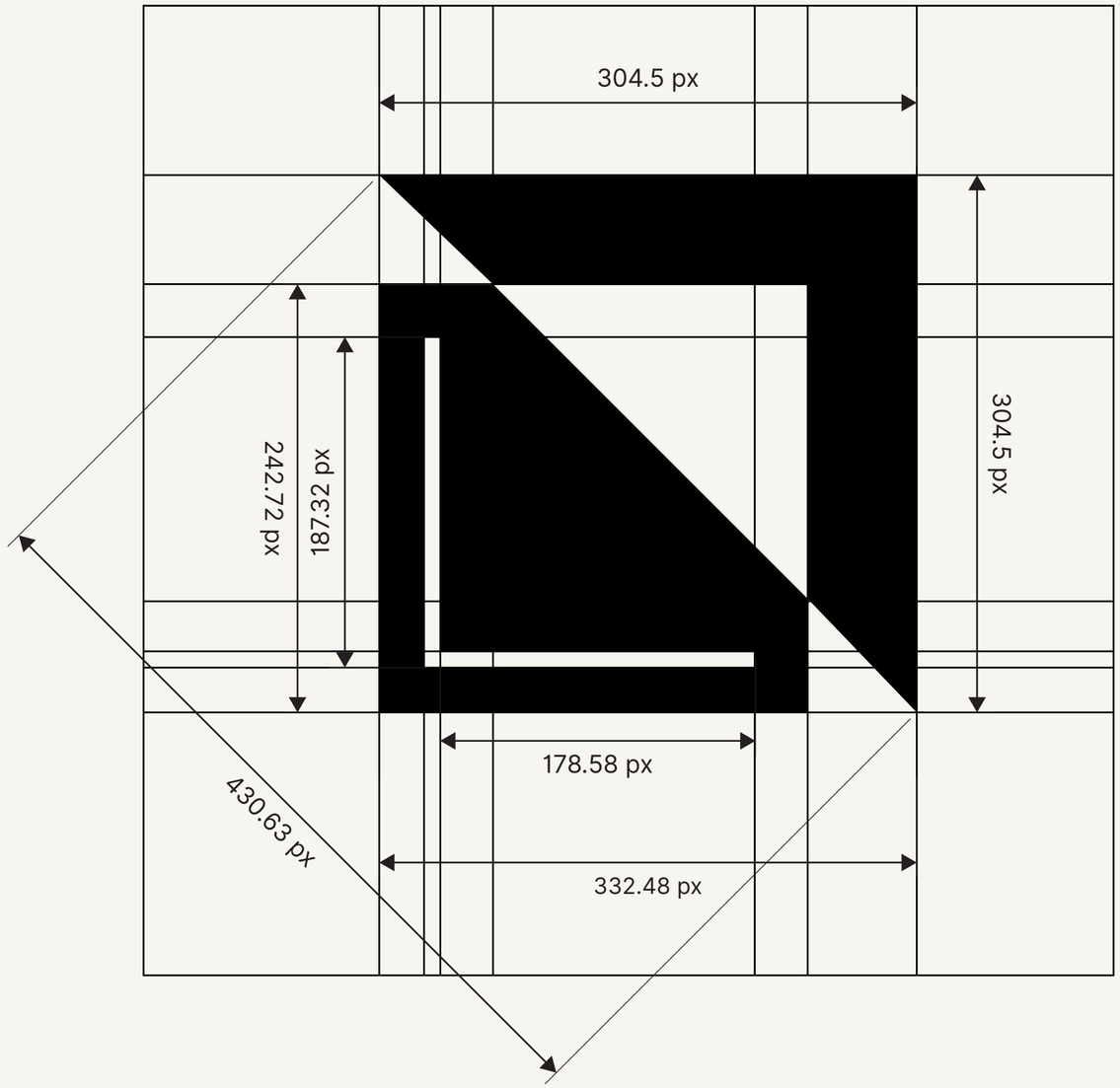
• Block mark: 304.5 px square. The 45° diagonal runs corner to corner at 430.63 px (304.5 × √2).

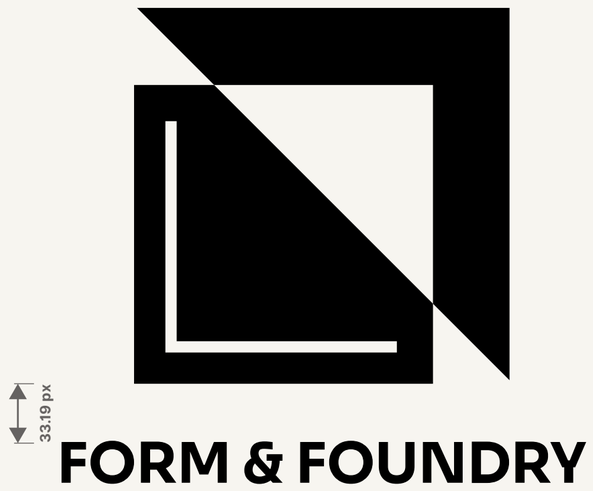
• Wordmark: 332.48 px wide — about 1.1× the width of the block — with a cap-height of 33.19 px.

• Gap: the space between the mark and the wordmark equals one wordmark cap-height (33.19 px as drawn).

CLOSING TIME

Scale the lockup as one unit with proportions locked. Never resize the mark and the wordmark independently.





Minimum Size

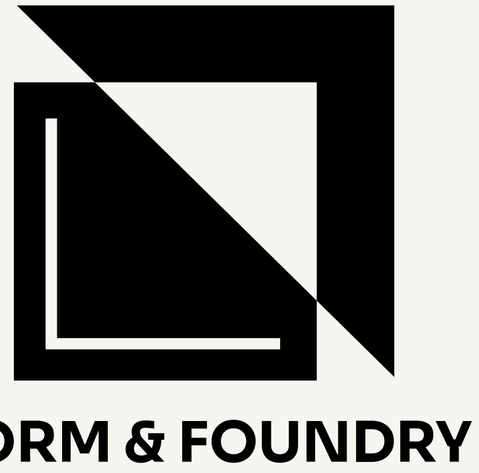
• Full lockup: 96 px wide on screen / 0.8 in (20 mm) in print.† Below this the wordmark stops being legible.

• Mark alone: 18 px on screen / 0.22 in in print.

• The scale ladder shows the full lockup shrinking to 75%. Below that point, switch to the mark alone (shown at 50% and 25%). Below the mark's minimum, do not use the logo — set the name in text instead.

• Minimums apply to the logo as it appears in final artwork, not to the size of the file.

125%



100%



75%



50%

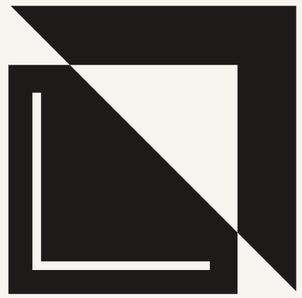


25%





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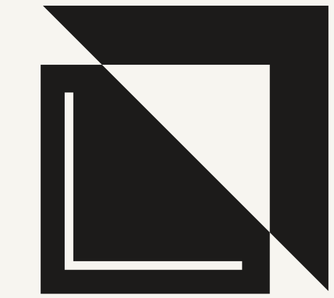
FORM & FOUNDRY



FORM & FOUNDRY



FORM & FOUNDRY

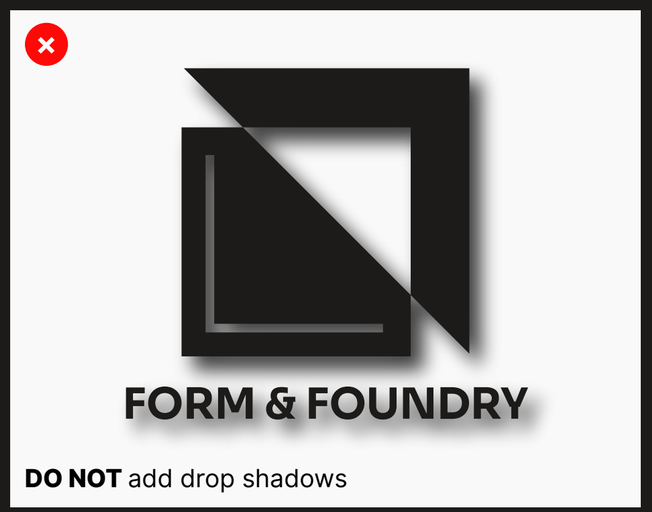


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Incorrect Usage



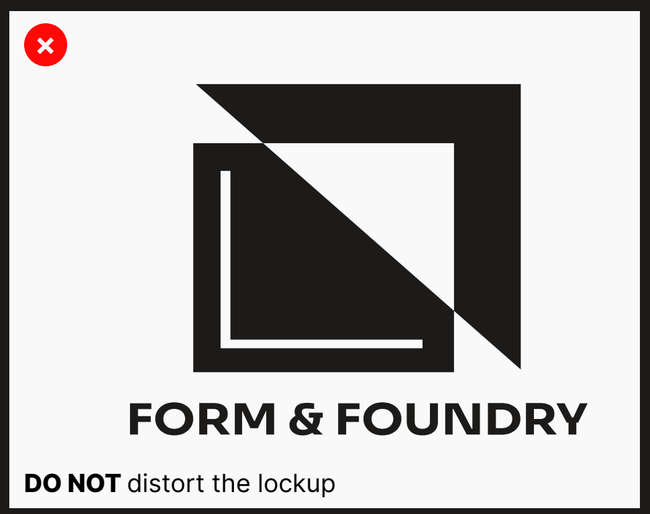
DO NOT skew the lockup



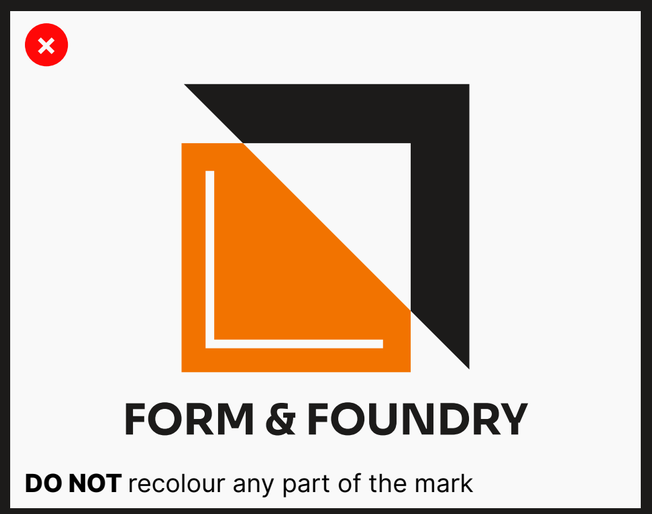
DO NOT add drop shadows



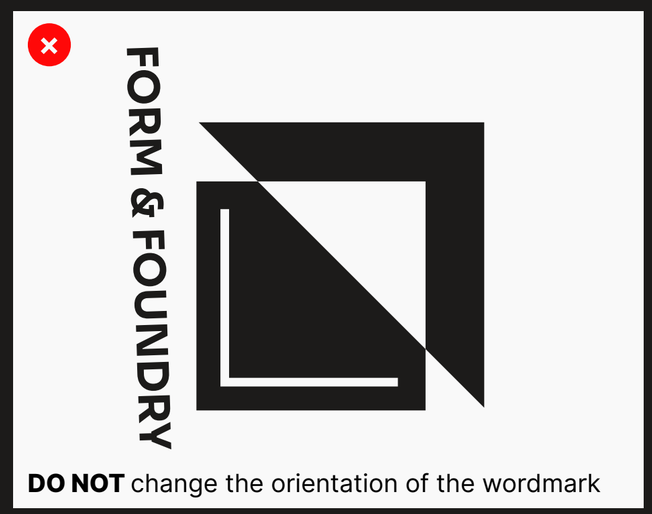
DO NOT rotate it



DO NOT distort the lockup



DO NOT recolour any part of the mark



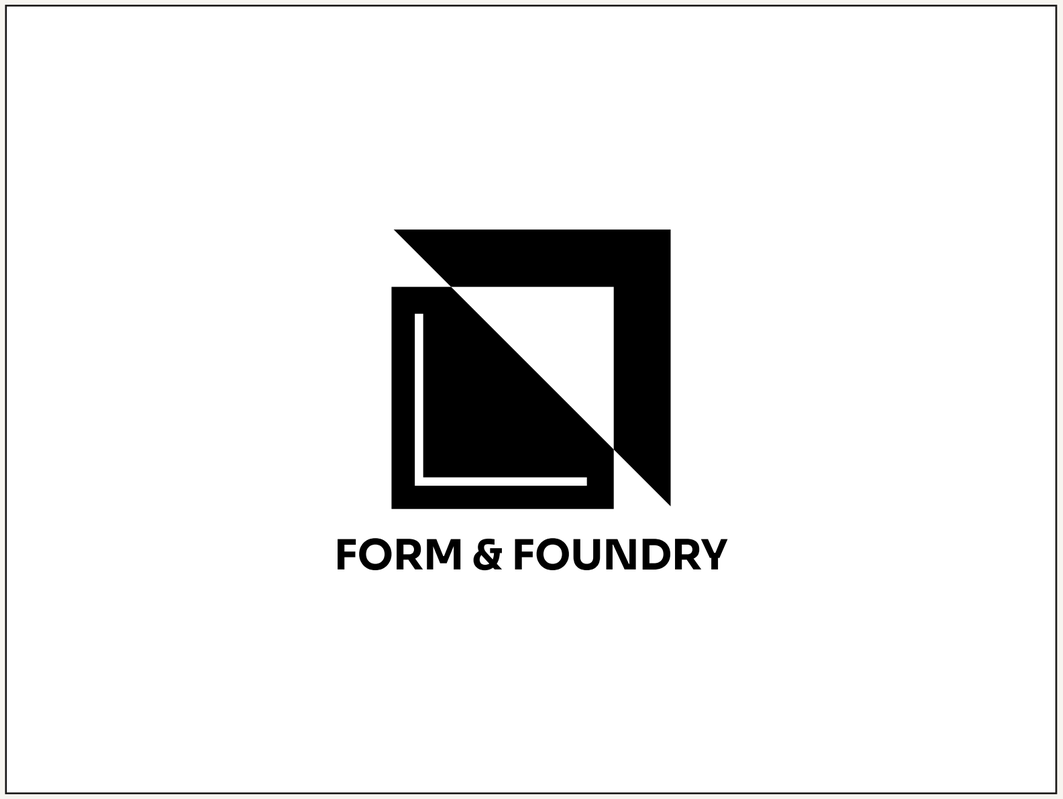
DO NOT change the orientation of the wordmark

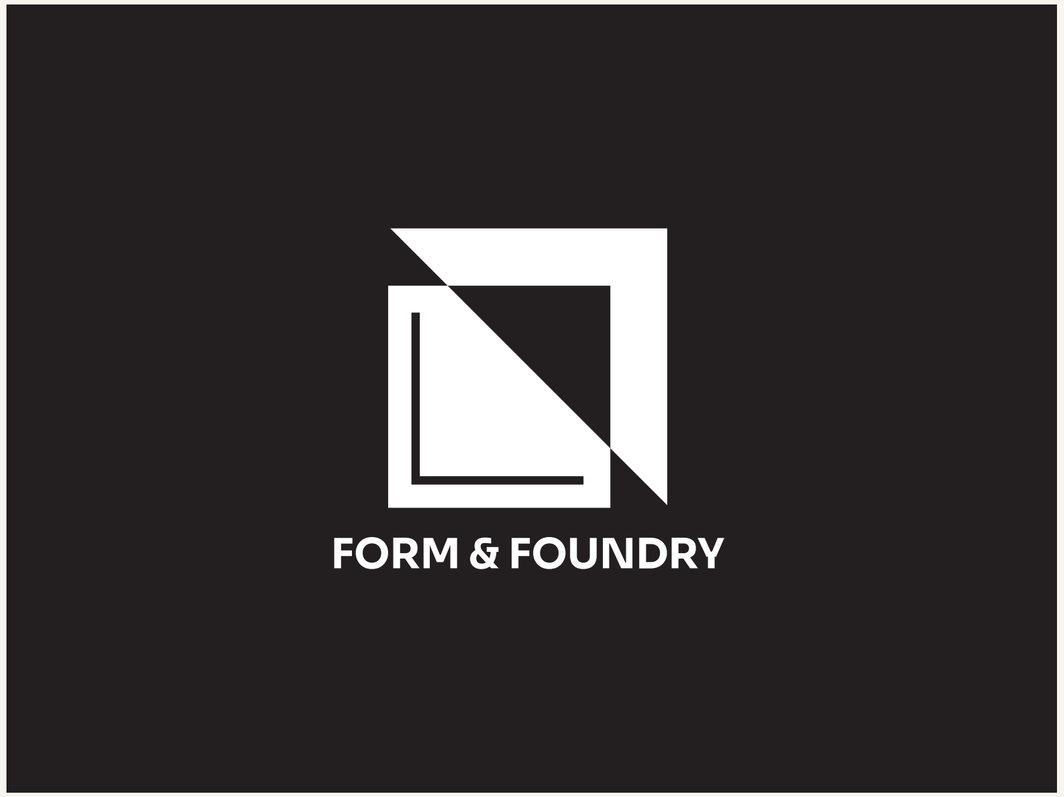
Monochrome

Use a single-ink version when colour cannot be reproduced — one-colour print, embossing, engraving, stamping, and some merchandise. It is the same artwork in one flat colour.

RULES

- 100% Charcoal — for light backgrounds
- 100% Off White — for dark backgrounds
- No tinted or screened versions
- Orange appears in the logo only through the colour versions on page 14.





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04

COLOUR SYSTEM

Form & Foundry — Brand Guidelines

Colour Ratio

Guide ratio across brand applications: 50% Charcoal, 35% Orange, 15% Off White — a noticeably bolder use of accent colour than a traditional consultancy. Orange is a main colour here, not a highlight. Ratios are by area across a layout, not per element.

PANTONE 419 C

CHARCOAL

HEX #1C1B1A
RGB 28 / 27 / 26
CMYK 69 / 64 / 64 / 70

PANTONE 1645 C

WARM ORANGE

HEX #FF6B35
RGB 255 / 107 / 53
CMYK 0 / 70 / 85 / 0

PANTONE COOL GRAY 1 C

OFF WHITE

HEX #F7F5F0
RGB 247 / 245 / 240
CMYK 2 / 2 / 6 / 0

Accessibility

Charcoal on Off White and Off White on Charcoal both comfortably exceed WCAG AA, at 15.8:1. Charcoal on Warm Orange and Warm Orange on Charcoal both measure 6.1:1 and also pass at every size. Warm Orange on Off White and Off White on Warm Orange both measure only 2.6:1 and fail — page 20 shows how to handle them.

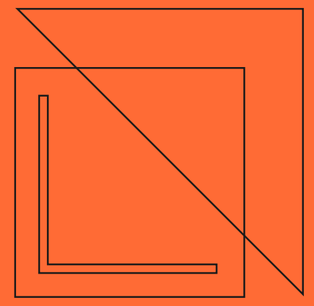
Combinations

✓

- Charcoal on Off White
- Off White on Charcoal
- Orange as a fill or accent with Charcoal or Off White text on top

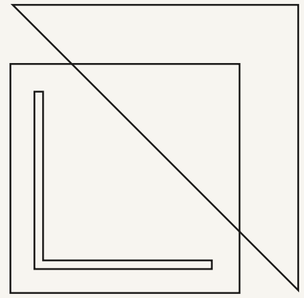
×

- Orange text on Off White — fails contrast at body size
- Charcoal on Orange for long-form text
- Off White text on Off White



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- Warm Orange text on Off White — 2.6:1, fails. For orange emphasis on a light page use Shade 2 (#A44B2A, 5.3:1).
- Off White text on Warm Orange — 2.6:1, fails. Use Charcoal. The exception is the logo and large display headlines in print or environmental signage, never text that must be read on screen.
- Charcoal text on Charcoal — any text in the same tone as its background.



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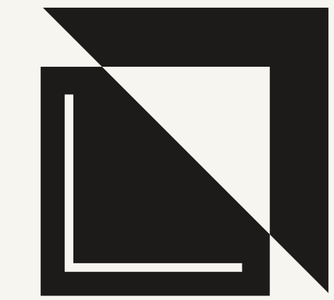


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- Charcoal on Off White — 15.8:1, all text sizes
- Off White on Charcoal — 15.8:1, all text sizes
- Charcoal on Warm Orange — 6.1:1, headlines, labels, buttons, and short copy
- Warm Orange on Charcoal — 6.1:1, headlines, emphasis, and UI accents



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Extended Colour Palettes

Beyond the three core colours, the palette extends only along the Warm Orange ramp: lighter tints and deeper shades of the same hue. Use the extended range for charts, illustration depth, hover and pressed states, and supporting backgrounds. The 50 / 35 / 15 ratio still belongs to the core three.

TINT 1

HEX #FF0035
RGB 255 / 0 / 33
CMYK 0 / 99 / 79 / 0

TINT 2

HEX #FDC70C
RGB 253/ 199 / 12
CMYK 1 / 21 / 99 / 0

TINT 3

HEX #3A3A3A
RGB 58 / 58 / 58
CMYK 0/ 0/ 0/ 0

TINT 4

HEX #93BD13
RGB 147 / 189 / 19
CMYK 48 / 6 / 100 / 0

TINT 5

HEX #93BDDF
RGB 147 / 189 / 223
CMYK 41 / 15 / 3 / 0

TINT 6

HEX #03367F
RGB 247 / 245 / 240
CMYK 100 / 29 / 2 / 8

TINT 7

HEX #FF895D
RGB 255 / 137 / 93
CMYK 0 / 57 / 65 / 0

Gradient and Tints

F7F5F0

F9D9CB

FABEA5

FCA280

FF6B35

D25B30

A44B2A

773B25

492B1F

1C1B1A

Brand gradient: Warm Orange to Charcoal, used behind the fluted texture on covers, section dividers, and large-format signage.
Flat tints and shades: charts, tables, and interface states.

TYPOGRAPHY

Form & Foundry — Brand Guidelines

Primary Typeface — Sora

Sora is the voice of the brand on the page: geometric, wide, and confident. It sets headlines, display type, navigation, interface labels, and the wordmark.

Weights in use: Regular 400, SemiBold 600, Bold 700, and ExtraBold 800. Light and Medium are not part of the system — thin strokes disappear at small sizes and soften a graphic language built on heavy forms.



Display Type

Sora Bold or ExtraBold, with tight leading (100–105%), frequently set in uppercase for high-energy headlines and section markers.

Set uppercase for short lines — up to about six words. Use sentence case for anything longer, so it stays easy to read.

Secondary Typeface — Inter

Inter is the working typeface. It sets body copy, captions, tables, forms, and long-form reading. It is neutral by design, so Sora can carry the personality.

Weights in use: Regular 400 for body copy, Medium 500 for captions, and SemiBold 600 and Bold 700 for emphasis and labels. ExtraBold 800 appears only in the specimen.

Body Type

Inter Regular, 16–18 px, 150–160% line height. Keep lines to about 50–75 characters.



Weights & Hierarchy

- H1 · Headline — Sora ExtraBold, 44–64 px, line height 100–105%
- H2 · Sub-headline — Sora Bold, 28–34 px, line height 110%
- H3 · Section title — Sora SemiBold, 20–24 px, line height 115%
- Body — Inter Regular, 16–18 px, line height 150–160%
- Caption — Inter Medium, 12–13 px, uppercase, +6% tracking

Space between levels is 1x between H1 and H2, 1x between H2 and H3, and 1.5x between H3 and body, where x is the font size of the element that follows.†

Paragraph Rules

- Left-aligned only.
- Short, punchy paragraphs — 2 to 4 sentences.
- Warm Orange for a single bolded word or phrase per section, never full paragraphs. Use it on Charcoal backgrounds only; on Off White, emphasise with bold Charcoal or Shade 2 (#A44B2A).

Digital Usage

Sora for UI, headlines, and navigation; Inter for body copy. Fallback stack: Sora → Poppins → sans-serif; Inter → Helvetica → sans-serif.

Print Usage

Same pairing throughout. Headline tracking tightened slightly at large sizes. Body copy no smaller than 10 pt in printed decks.

44–64px

Headline

1x

28–34px

Sub-headline

1x

20–24px

Sub-headline

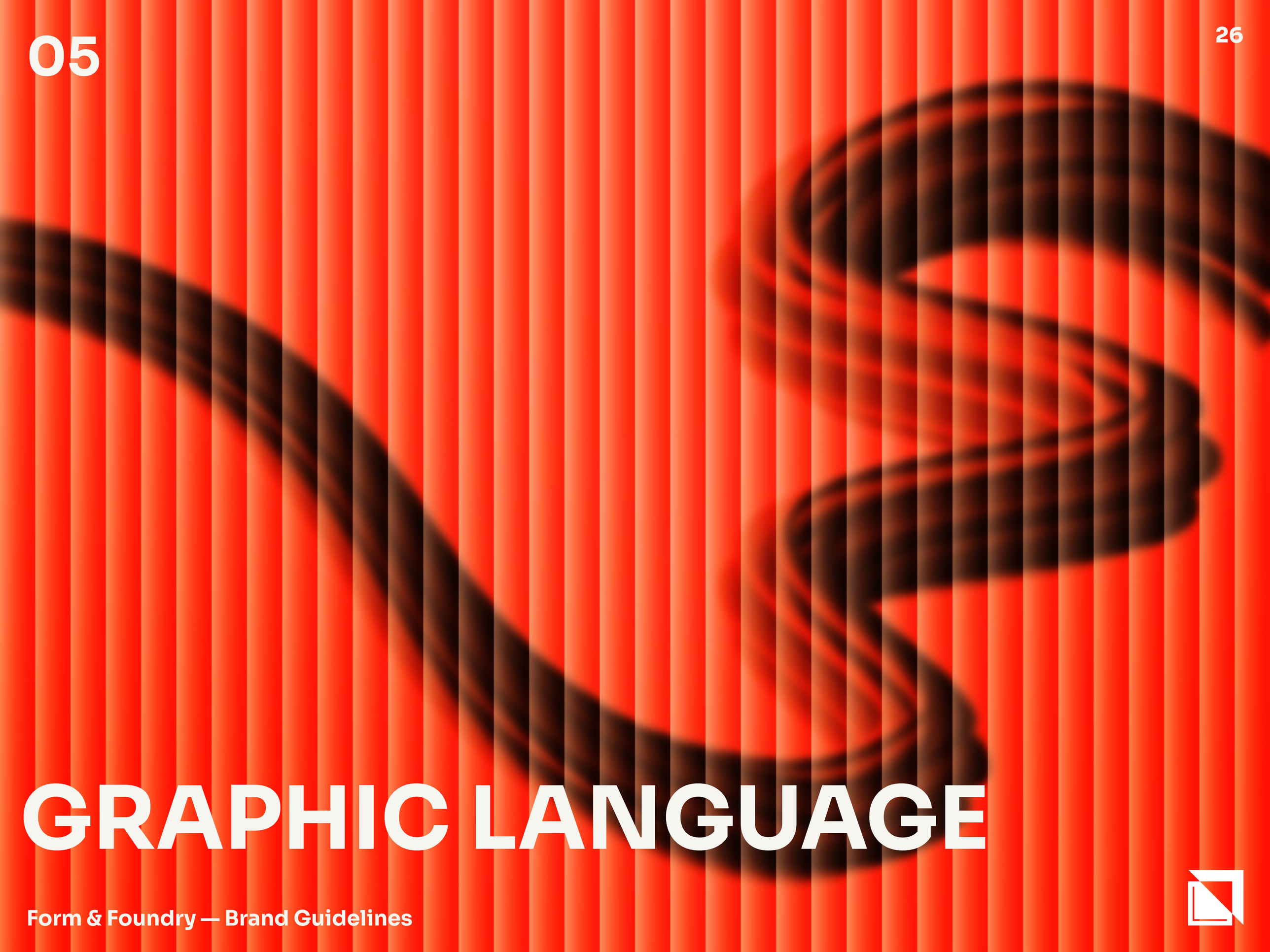
1, 1/2x

16–18px

Body of the text

12–13px

CAPTION TEXT FOR SOCIAL MEDIA AND OTHER ADVERTISING UNITS.



GRAPHIC LANGUAGE

Shapes

Squares and triangles lead, drawn from the logomark's "raw block" motif. Use them as a flexible grid of shapes that can be combined, rotated, and overlapped. A circle appears as a minor third shape — an accent for indicators, bullets, and toggles — never as a container or part of the logo.

Lines

Bold 2–3 px Charcoal or Orange rules act as strong section dividers, not thin hairlines. This brand reads heavier and more graphic than a traditional consultancy.

Grids

An asymmetric modular grid rather than a strict 12-column system — intentional off-balance compositions that still feel controlled. Build on one base module, let elements break the grid on one side only, and keep margins consistent so the imbalance reads as deliberate.

Patterns

Two textures. The zigzag block pattern — interlocking Orange and Charcoal chevrons — for cards, badges, and packaging. The fluted gradient — vertical ribs of Orange fading to Charcoal, with a dark ribbon form — for covers, section dividers, and large-format backdrops. Never run text directly over either; set it on a solid block.

Containers

Sharp or slightly clipped-corner blocks, with one corner cut at 45° to echo the logomark's diagonal. Rounded corners are not part of the container language; full-round pills are for interface controls only, such as toggles, sliders, and tags.

Dividers

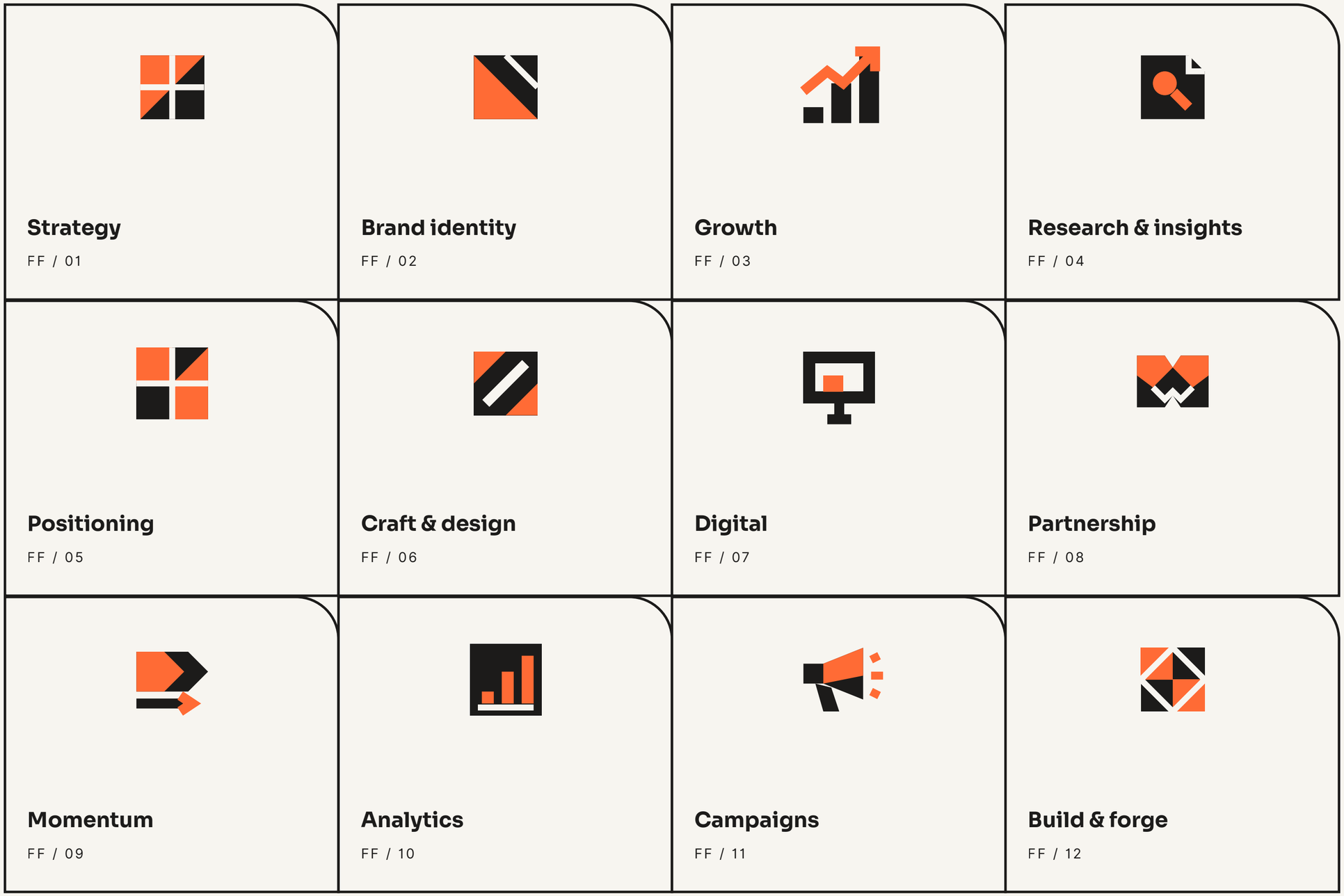
Bold, solid-colour rules, occasionally offset from the margin for visual tension. Lines set the weight (2–3 px); dividers set the placement — full-width to separate sections, offset to create tension, never decorative.



Iconography

A solid, filled geometric icon set — bolder and more graphic than line icons. Icons are built on a square grid, with Charcoal as the main shape and a single Warm Orange accent shape.

Many icons draw on the square-and-triangle vocabulary of the logomark. Pictographic icons — monitor, megaphone, charts — follow the same rules: solid shapes, one orange accent, no outlines.



PHOTOGRAPHY DIRECTION


POST
BODYCARE
1HOUR
REFUELING
ADAPTOGEN






ERROR
ERROR
ERROR




TENNESSEE
2











08

BRAND VOICE

Communication Personality

The sharp creative partner — energetic, opinionated, direct, occasionally playful, always grounded in a clear reason.

Writing Principles

Open with a bold statement, then justify it
Favour short, punchy sentences mixed with an occasional longer one for rhythm
Use active voice and strong verbs — forge, build, sharpen, shape

Vocabulary

Use: forge, shape, craft, distinct, sharp, momentum, build. Avoid: solutions-oriented, best-in-class, synergy, world-class.

Headlines

Bold, punchy, occasionally playful. Example: “We forge brands.” / “Raw ideas. Sharp brands.”

Body Copy

Confident and specific, backed by a point of view. “Generic brands blend in. We build ones that don't,” not “we help you stand out.”

CTA Style

Energetic, action-first. “Lvet's build something” / “Start the forge.”

Example Messaging

Homepage headline: “We forge brands.”
Subhead: “Form & Foundry turns raw ideas into distinctive brands through strategy, design, and digital craft.”
CTA: “Start the forge”

Do's & Don'ts

Do use fragments for punch when it serves rhythm
Do take a clear point of view
Don't ramble
Don't overuse exclamation marks — confidence doesn't need to shout

BRAND APPLICATIONS


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Want to start a brand but don't know where to start?
Let's build something
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FORM & FOUNDRY

LET'S FORM YOUR FUTURE

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FOUNDRY
LET'S FORGE THE FUTURE


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LET'S FORM
YOUR FUTURE